INGLÉS · NIVEL B1 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Voz Pasiva en Inglés B1 — Present y Past Simple Passive

Aprende a transformar oraciones activas en pasivas y a usarlas correctamente en textos formales, noticias y descripciones de procesos.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Usar la voz pasiva en presente y pasado para cambiar el foco de una oración y escribir textos formales con naturalidad.

MODELO

The report is written by the manager. / The castle was built in 1420. / English is spoken in over 50 countries.

Al terminar podrás

1. Forma el presente simple pasivo con am/is/are + participio pasado
2. Forma el pasado simple pasivo con was/were + participio pasado
3. Usa "by + agente" correctamente y sabe cuándo omitirlo
4. Identifica cuándo usar la pasiva: foco en el objeto, agente desconocido o irrelevante

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve la práctica y corrige al final. Usa las tres pistas de audio de la lección web para imitar ritmo y entonación.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

La voz pasiva en inglés (am/is/are/was/were + participio pasado) cambia el foco de la oración: el objeto de la acción se convierte en el sujeto. En nivel B1 dominas el presente y pasado simple pasivo, el uso opcional de "by + agente" y los contextos donde la pasiva es preferida: textos formales, reportajes, ciencia e instrucciones.

¿Qué es la voz pasiva y para qué sirve?

En una oración activa, el sujeto realiza la acción: "The chef cooked the meal." En la voz pasiva, el objeto de esa acción se convierte en el sujeto: "The meal was cooked by the chef." El foco cambia: ahora nos interesa más "the meal" que "the chef".

La pasiva no es simplemente una variación estilística — tiene una función comunicativa clara. La usas cuando el agente (quien hace la acción) es desconocido, obvio o poco importante, y cuando el objeto de la acción merece el foco de la oración.

Cómo se forma: presente y pasado simple pasivo

Presente simple pasivo: am/is/are + participio pasado. El auxiliar (am/is/are) concuerda con el nuevo sujeto (el objeto original). "English is taught in most schools." / "The tests are corrected automatically." / "I am paid monthly."

Pasado simple pasivo: was/were + participio pasado. Was para I/he/she/it; were para you/we/they. "The Eiffel Tower was built in 1889." / "The reports were submitted last week." / "A new law was passed yesterday."

Activa	Pasiva presente	Pasiva pasado
Someone cleans the office.	The office is cleaned.	The office was cleaned.
They speak Spanish here.	Spanish is spoken here.	Spanish was spoken here.
Workers built the bridge.	The bridge is (now) built.	The bridge was built.

By + agente: cuándo incluirlo y cuándo omitirlo

El agente (quien realiza la acción) puede añadirse con "by" si es importante o nuevo para el lector: "The Sistine Chapel was painted by Michelangelo." Aquí Michelangelo es la información nueva y relevante.

Pero en muchos contextos el agente se omite: "My car was stolen." (No sabemos quién.) / "The building was closed due to a fire." (Es obvio que fue la autoridad.) / "The results are published every month." (Es una norma general; quién lo hace no importa.) Incluir el agente cuando es obvio suena torpe: evita "The window was broken by someone."

La pasiva en textos formales, noticias y ciencia

La voz pasiva es mucho más frecuente en inglés académico, científico y periodístico que en la conversación cotidiana. En ciencia se usa para describir procesos objetivamente: "The samples were collected and analyzed." / "The results were recorded every 24 hours." El foco está en el proceso, no en los investigadores.

En noticias y reportajes la pasiva evita comprometer al reportero: "Three people were arrested." / "A new vaccine has been developed." / "The decision was made at the highest level." Para el IELTS Academic Writing Task 1, la pasiva es esencial para describir procesos y diagramas.

Participios pasados irregulares más frecuentes en pasiva

Para usar la pasiva correctamente debes conocer los participios pasados irregulares más comunes. Algunos de los más frecuentes: write written, build built, make made, break broken, give given, take taken, know known, find found, see seen, speak spoken, sell sold, send sent.

Un error muy común es usar el pasado simple en lugar del participio: "It was wrote" en lugar de "It was written." El auxiliar was/were ya indica el tiempo — el participio nunca cambia: siempre written, built, made, no matter the person.

¿Cómo se forma la voz pasiva en inglés?

Con el verbo to be (en el tiempo que toque) + participio pasado: "The house is cleaned", "The letter was written", "The work will be done". El objeto de la activa pasa a sujeto. Quien hace la acción se introduce con "by" si se menciona: "The book was written by Leo".

¿Cuándo se usa la voz pasiva en inglés?

Cuando el foco está en la acción o el objeto, no en quién la hace, o cuando el agente es desconocido o irrelevante: "English is spoken here", "My car was stolen". Es muy común en textos formales, noticias e instrucciones.

¿Cómo se pasa de la voz activa a la pasiva en inglés?

El objeto de la activa se convierte en sujeto, el verbo pasa a "to be + participio" en el mismo tiempo, y el sujeto original va con "by" (opcional). "They built the bridge" "The bridge was built (by them)".

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

Subject + am/is/are (present) or was/were (past) + past participle [+ by + agent]

Decide en este orden

1. Presente simple pasivo: am/is/are + participio "Coffee is grown in Colombia." / "The results are checked every day."
2. Pasado simple pasivo: was/were + participio "The bridge was built in 1890." / "The emails were sent this morning."
3. Por/By + agente: añade quién hizo la acción (solo si es relevante o nuevo) "The poem was written by García Lorca."
4. Omite el agente si es desconocido, irrelevante o general "My bike was stolen." (no sabemos quién) / "The store is closed at 8." (es una norma general).
5. Cuándo usar pasiva: (1) el agente es desconocido/irrelevante, (2) el objeto de la acción es más importante, (3) estilo formal, académico o de noticias.
6. Preguntas en pasiva: Is/Are/Was/Were + subject + past participle? "Was the letter sent?" / "Are the tickets included?"

Tiempo	Estructura	Ejemplo
Present simple passive	am/is/are + past participle	The results are announced today.
Past simple passive	was/were + past participle	The building was designed in 1900.
Negative	is not / was not + past participle	The report wasn't finished on time.

Errores frecuentes

× "The book was wrote by Márquez" "The book was written by Márquez" — usa el participio pasado, no el pasado simple.

× "It is build in 1950" "It was built in 1950" — fecha histórica pasado (was/were), no presente.

× "The car is driven by he" "The car is driven by him" — after "by" usa pronombre objeto (him, her, them, us).

02 · MAPA VISUAL

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

English is spoken in over 80 countries.	El inglés se habla en más de 80 países.
The report was submitted yesterday morning.	El informe fue entregado ayer por la mañana.
A new hospital is being built near the city center.	Se está construyendo un nuevo hospital cerca del centro.
The ancient temple was built over 2,000 years ago.	El templo antiguo fue construido hace más de 2.000 años.
Are tourists allowed to enter without a guide?	¿Se permite la entrada a turistas sin guía?
Three suspects were arrested last night.	Tres sospechosos fueron arrestados anoche.
The new policy was announced by the president.	La nueva política fue anunciada por el presidente.
These products are manufactured in Colombia.	Estos productos se fabrican en Colombia.

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

21 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

Reconoce la forma pasiva correcta

1. This cathedral ___ in the 15th century. Opciones: was built · is built · built · were built

2. These cars ___ in South Korea. Opciones: are manufactured · is manufactured · manufactured · was manufactured

3. Two people ___ in the accident last night. Opciones: were injured · are injured · injured · was injured

4. This device ___ in a dry, cool place. Opciones: should be stored · should stored · is store · was storing

5. "Don Quixote" ___ by Miguel de Cervantes. Opciones: was written · wrote · is written · were written

6. The experiment ___ three times to confirm the results. Opciones: was repeated · repeated · is repeated · were repeated

7. All invoices ___ by the accounting department before payment. Opciones: are checked · is checked · checked · were checked

8. ___ credit cards accepted in this shop? Opciones: Are · Is · Were · Was

Activa a pasiva en contexto

9. Workers build these shoes by hand. These shoes _____ _____ by hand. Opciones: are · is · were · was / built · build · building · built up

10. A famous painting _____ from the museum last night. The thieves _____ by police the following morning. Opciones: was stolen · is stolen · stole · were stolen / were caught · was caught · caught · are caught

11. The telephone _____ by Alexander Graham Bell in 1876. The first call _____ to his assistant, Watson. Opciones: was invented · is invented · invented · were invented / was made · is made · made · were made

12. First, the coffee beans _____ carefully by hand. Then they _____ and packaged. Opciones: are selected · is selected · select · were selected / are roasted · is roasted · roasted · were roasted

Producción de café colombiano

13. Colombian coffee is known worldwide for its quality. The coffee plants _____ (grow) on mountain slopes at high altitude. The ripe cherries _____ (pick) by hand — this is what makes Colombian coffee special. After harvesting, the beans _____ (remove) from the fruit and _____ (wash) in clean water. Then they _____ (dry) in the sun for several days. Finally, the beans _____ (sort) by size and quality and _____ (export) to more than 60 countries around the world.

Transforma y completa

14. The WeLearn building has an interesting history. It _____ (design) by a famous local architect in 1975. The original walls _____ (make) of traditional stone. Today, the building _____ (use) as a language academy. New technologies _____ (install) every year to improve the learning experience. Last month, new interactive boards _____ (add) to every classroom.

Producción guiada

15. Escribe una oración sobre cuándo fue construido o fundado un lugar famoso en tu país (usa was/were + participio).

_____

16. Describe algo que se hace regularmente en tu trabajo o escuela usando presente simple pasivo (is/are + participio).

_____

17. Escribe una oración sobre algo que ocurrió recientemente en tu ciudad o país, en voz pasiva (was/were + participio).

_____

18. Escribe dónde se fabrica o hace algo que usas a diario (usa is/are + made/produced/manufactured).

_____

Misión: Describe un proceso

19. Escribe el primer paso del proceso en voz pasiva (presente simple: is/are + participio).

_____

20. Escribe el segundo paso usando un participio diferente (is/are + participio).

_____

21. Escribe el paso final del proceso (can also use "finally" + is/are + participio).

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. was built — Pasado simple pasivo: "This cathedral" (singular) was built. La catedral fue construida en el siglo XV.
2. are manufactured — Presente simple pasivo: "these cars" (plural) are manufactured. Producción habitual presente.
3. were injured — Pasado simple pasivo: "two people" (plural) were injured. Acontecimiento pasado en una noticia.
4. should be stored — Modal + pasiva: should + be + past participle should be stored. Instrucción de almacenamiento.
5. was written — Pasado simple pasivo con agente was written by. Cervantes es la información nueva e importante.
6. was repeated — Pasado simple pasivo: "the experiment" (singular) was repeated. Contexto científico, foco en el proceso.
7. are checked — Presente simple pasivo (proceso habitual): "all invoices" (plural) are checked.
8. Are — Pregunta en presente pasivo: Are + plural subject + past participle? Are credit cards accepted?
9. are / built — "These shoes" es plural are (presente simple pasivo). Build built (participio pasado irregular). Se necesita el participio, no el pasado simple.
10. was stolen / were caught — "A famous painting" (singular) + pasado was stolen. "The thieves" (plural) + pasado were caught.
11. was invented / was made — "The telephone" (singular) + pasado histórico was invented. "The first call" (singular) + pasado was made. Make made (participio irregular).
12. are selected / are roasted — "The coffee beans" (plural) + proceso habitual are selected (presente pasivo). "They" (plural) + proceso habitual are roasted.
13. are grown / are picked / are removed / are washed / are dried / are sorted / are exported — "The coffee plants" (plural) + proceso habitual are grown. "The ripe cherries" (plural) + proceso habitual are picked. "The beans" (plural) + proceso habitual are removed. Continuando la serie de procesos habituales are washed. "They" (plural) + proceso habitual are dried. "The beans" (plural) + proceso habitual are sorted. Último paso del proceso: are exported. Plural are.
14. was designed / were made / is used / are installed / were added — Pasado simple pasivo: "it" (singular) + fecha en el pasado was designed. "The original walls" (plural) + pasado were made. Make made (irregular). "The building" (singular) + uso habitual presente is used. "New technologies" (plural) + presente habitual are installed. "New interactive boards" (plural) + pasado (last month) were added.
15. The Gold Museum in Bogotá was opened in 1968. — Ejemplo: The cathedral was built in the 16th century. / The national park was founded in 1952.
16. Homework is checked every Monday by the teacher. — Ejemplo: Reports are submitted every Friday. / English is taught from primary school.
17. A new metro line was opened in Bogotá last year. — Ejemplo: Three suspects were arrested last week. / A new stadium was built for the games.
18. My phone is made in South Korea. — Ejemplo: These shoes are made in Italy. / Coffee is grown in the mountains of Colombia.
19. First, the cocoa beans are collected from the trees. — Ejemplo: First, the raw material is collected. / The grapes are harvested in autumn.
20. Then, the beans are roasted at a high temperature. — Ejemplo: Then, the material is processed in a machine. / The beans are ground into powder.
21. Finally, the chocolate is packed and sold in stores around the world. — Ejemplo: Finally, the product is packaged and delivered. / The finished goods are shipped to retailers.

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.